

# Appendix H — University Letter of Interest (Template)

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*Template drafted by Yusuf Quadri, Founder & CEO, DEQUAD Ltd.*

This appendix provides the template used by DEQUAD when seeking a Letter of Interest or formal Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) from a pilot university. Letters returned by partner institutions will be attached to this appendix as they arrive.

The template below is co-signed by the partner-university point of contact (typically the Director of Student Services or Head of Wellbeing Services) and the DEQUAD founder.

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## Template: Letter of Interest

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*(On partner-university letterhead.)*

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

**To:** UK Endorsement Services Ltd

**Subject:** Letter of Interest in piloting DEQUAD at [University Name]

To whom it may concern,

I am writing in my capacity as **[Job Title]** at the **University of Bedfordshire** to confirm our institutional interest in piloting the DEQUAD platform (developed by DEQUAD Ltd, co-founded by Yusuf Quadri — formerly Bedfordshire SU President 2021–2023 — and Yusuff Adeagbo, CTO) during academic year 2026/27.

## Background

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[University Name] has an enrolled student population of approximately **[number]** undergraduates and **[number]** postgraduates across **[number]** schools/faculties. Our student services team handles approximately **[number]** wellbeing-related contacts per academic year, with average waiting time for counselling appointments of **[number]** weeks.

## Why we are interested in DEQUAD

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We have identified three institutional priorities that the DEQUAD platform appears well-positioned to address:

1. **Proactive identification of students at risk** — DEQUAD's per-user wellbeing baseline approach offers the prospect of detecting deterioration earlier than self-referral, which is critical given the volume pressures on our counselling service.
2. **Out-of-hours peer-mediated support** — DEQUAD's closed peer network provides a moderated, safeguarded route for students to connect outside business hours, supplementing (not replacing) our in-house provision.
3. **Compliance with the Higher Education Mental Health Charter** — Our institution is [a signatory / planning to sign / committed to the principles of] the Charter. DEQUAD's design aligns with the Charter's whole-university approach and the "Step Change" framework.

## Pilot scope (subject to procurement and DPIA completion)

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Subject to satisfactory completion of our procurement process, including: - A joint Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA); - A Data Processing Agreement compliant with UK GDPR; - Information-security due diligence (Cyber Essentials Plus required); - An agreed safeguarding escalation protocol;

...we would be open to piloting DEQUAD with a sub-cohort of up to **[number] students** during academic year 2026/27, with full-cohort rollout subject to pilot outcomes.

## Indicative pricing acceptance

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The pricing point of **£1.50 per enrolled student per annum** discussed with the DEQUAD team is within the indicative range we have allocated for digital-wellbeing tooling in the 2026/27 budget cycle.

## No commitment at this stage

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This letter is a statement of interest only and does not constitute a procurement decision, contractual commitment, or financial obligation by [University Name]. Any binding

commitment will follow our standard procurement, legal, and DPIA processes.

## Contact

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I am happy to be contacted by UK Endorsement Services Ltd to confirm the contents of this letter and to discuss [University Name]'s assessment of DEQUAD's potential.

**Yours sincerely,**

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**[Name]** [Job Title] [University Name] [Email] [Phone]

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## Letters received to date

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| University               | Signed by                            | Date  | Status          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------|-----------------|
| University of Manchester | <i>Pending — discussion underway</i> | _____ | Verbal interest |
| ____                     | ____                                 | _____ | ____            |
| ____                     | ____                                 | _____ | ____            |

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## Notes for UKES assessor

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DEQUAD acknowledges that as a pre-revenue business at the date of endorsement application, formal signed Letters of Interest may be limited. Where formal letters are not yet returned, the applicant will provide:

- Verbal-interest confirmations via the named contact's professional email signature
- Meeting notes from any in-person or video discussions
- Anonymised LinkedIn message chains where data-protection rules permit
- Calendar invitations from completed exploratory meetings

These are attached as supporting evidence in the **H\_supporting/** folder.